



La Liga

Real Madrid had the perfect chance to stamp early authority in its title defence, facing lowly Mallorca in its league opener. The news of Mbappe making his league debut naturally dominated discussions.



However, it was an anti-climactic start for Los Blancos as not only did Mbappe fail to find the net, but Mallorca also held it to a hard-fought 1-1 draw. However, Carlo Ancelotti's men bounced back strongly, beating Real Valladolid 3-0 the following week. It was a match where Madrid's young blood shined brightly. While Federico Valverde and Brahim Diaz found the net and kept the Santiago Bernabeu crowd happy, the loudest cheer was reserved for Endrick, who had a dream debut, scoring Madrid's third goal deep in second-half stoppage time.

Barcelona has been in the news for all the wrong reasons, mainly due to its financial constraints. It started the campaign with a 2-1 win against Valencia, courtesy of a brace from Robert Lewandowski after Hugo Duro gave Valencia the lead just before halftime in the 44th minute. Lewandowski carried his goal-scoring momentum into Barcelona's next match against Athletic Bilbao, scoring again in a 2-1 win, with Euro 2024 star Lamine

On target: Endrick had a dream debut, scoring Real Madrid's third goal against Real Valladolid. **Left:** Robert Lewandowski does what he does best, scoring at will. REUTERS

Yamal scoring the other.

Atletico Madrid flexed its muscles in the transfer market to challenge Real Madrid and Barcelona for the league title. With new signings like Alexander Sorloth, Julian Alvarez, and Robin Le Normand, Diego Simeone hopes his team can go the distance as it did in the 2020-21 season. In its season opener, Sorloth began his Atletico career on a high, scoring on his league debut, but his team drew 2-2 against Villarreal.

After a shaky start, Atletico needed a strong response in front of home fans, but it wasn't going to be an easy task, with Girona as its opponent, a team that upended the usual La Liga narrative last season by challenging for the title at one point, eventually finishing third and grabbing a Champions League spot. Atletico's response, however, was